Caves and Caverns

Caves and caverns are subterranean features of karst topography. Caves are hollows that are formed by the dissolution of limestone rocks when carbon di oxide in air turns into carbonic acid after its reaction with water. They vary in size and shape. Caverns are the caves with irregular floors. Eg. Guptadham caves in Western Bihar.

All types of deposits in the caves and caverns are collectively called **speleothems** which **includes travertines, tufa, dripstones**.

Swallow Holes, Uvalas, Dolines, Poljis are other erossional Features of karst regions predominant in other parts of the world.


cave

Facts

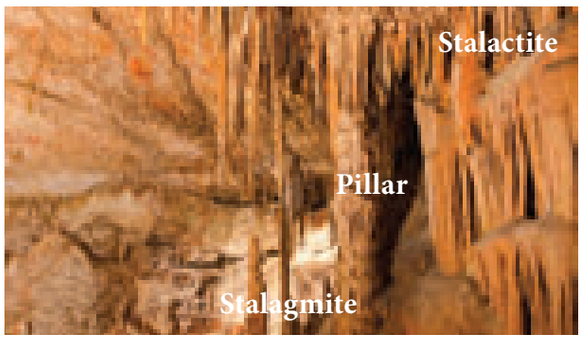
Cave insects lose their senses of sight and develop extraordinary long antenna to compensate the loss of sight

Depositional Landforms of Underground Water

It is interesting to know that a variety of depositional features are formed on the floor, ceiling and walls of the caves and caverns of the Karst Topography.

Stalactite, Stalagmite and Column

When the water containing dissolved calcite gradually drips from the ceiling of the caves, water evaporates and the remaining calcite hangs from the ceiling. Thus **Stalactites** are formed. When the calcite deposits rises upward like a pillar **Stalagmites** are formed. Sometimes, Stalactites and Stalagmites meet together to form **Columns or Pillars**.



Glaciers:

A Glacier is a large mass of ice that moves slowly over the land, from its place of accumulation. It is also known as 'River of ice'. The place of accumulation is called snowfield. **The height above which there is a permanent snow cover in the higher altitude or latitude is called snowline.** Higher the latitude, lower the snowline from sea level.

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Hots

Snowline of Alps is 2700 metre where as the snowline of Greenland is just 600 metre. Find out the reason.

Activity

Fake Snow

Materials needed:-Cup of Baking Soda, Shaving Cream

Method:-Pour one cup of baking soda,

Spray the shaving cream

The snow will start forming almost immediately..

The gradual transformation of snow into granular ice is called 'firn' or ' neve' and finally it becomes solid glacial ice.

Erosional Landforms of Glacier

Glaciers are powerful erosive agents. Some of the important erosional landforms are

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